



MASSACHUSETTS

Department of Elementary
and Secondary Education

Student Course Schedule (SCS) Data Handbook — Version 9.5

October 1, 2026

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Introduction

The Student Course Schedule System (SCS) is an online, secure data collection of the courses taken by students in the public school districts of Massachusetts. SCS collects data at the student and course levels.

This handbook provides a detailed description of the data elements required in SCS. Each record that is submitted must contain an acceptable value in each data element and may not be left blank.

The following information is provided for each data element:

Name — Name of the data element.

Description — A brief definition of the element.

Source — Location of source material, if applicable.

Data Type — Alphanumeric or Integer.

Maximum Length — The maximum number of characters allowed.

Minimum Length — The minimum number of characters allowed.

Acceptable Values — A list of the values that can be submitted to the Department.

If no values are listed, then any value of the acceptable type and length are permitted.

Related Data Elements— List of related data elements in SIMS and EPIMS

Notes — Additional information, related to the element, such as its relationship and dependence on other elements.

SIF Information – contains the SIF Object and SIF Element for this SCS data element.

SCS Data Elements

SCS01 Locally Assigned Student Identifier (LASID)

Unique Local Education Agency Assigned Student Identifier. Must have corresponding State assigned Student ID.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum: 1 Maximum 32

Acceptable Values/Code Description:

Set by LEA. The only special characters allowed in this field are the hyphen, apostrophe, period, and space.

Related Data Elements:

SIMS: DOE001 – Locally Assigned Student Identifier

SIF Information

Object: StudentPersonal

Element: LocalId

Values: Alphanumeric

SCS02 State-Assigned Student Identifier (SASID)

Unique 10-digit State Assigned Student Identifier

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 10 Maximum 10

Acceptable Values/Code Description:

10-digit state-assigned identification number.

Related Data Elements:

SIMS: DOE002 – State Assigned Student Identifier

Notes:

1. In order to track students within and across districts over time and to keep student information secure and confidential at both the state and local levels, two student identifiers will be used — one assigned by the district in which the student is enrolled (LASID) and a State Assigned number (SASID).
2. State Assigned Student Identifiers will be assigned through the State Student Registration System. Districts will need to use the State Assigned Student Identifier and the Locally Assigned Student Identifier on all individual data submitted to the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education.
3. This element will be used to match with SIMS data element DOE002.

SIF Information

Object: StudentPersonal

Element: StateProvinceId

Values: Alphanumeric

SCS03 School/Program ID Number

Indicates the location where a course is being taught. This code may differ from the school in which the student is enrolled. Each school in Massachusetts has a four-digit code assigned by DESE. In combination with the four-digit district code, each school in Massachusetts has a unique, eight-digit code number. Each student's course record must contain the eight-digit code of the school or institution where the course is being taught.

Alternative education programs can be reported in SCS as the location where a course is taught **if the course is not taught in a school**. If the course is taught in a school, the school code must be used for WA06 (and SCS03).

Districts will be able to report school codes **or** valid 8-digit district alternative education program codes in WA06 (and SCS03).

District alternative education program codes **must be registered with DESE**.

Alternative Education program codes will be cross-validated between EPIMS and SCS so students and teachers will be linked at the classroom level by the alternative education program code **OR** by the school code.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 8 Maximum 8

Acceptable Values/Code Description:

Set by State. Only school codes currently reported as being open in Directory Administration will be accepted.

To report course location for public schools in Massachusetts: Each school in Massachusetts has an eight-digit code assigned by DESE. The first four digits represent the district code. The second four digits represent the school code.

To report courses provided by colleges: The four digit college institution codes used to report degree institutions in the EPIMS staff roster file will be preceded by "CLBR" (all uppercase letters only) to form the 8 character code.

The following two codes will be used to report online (virtual) courses:

"CLBRVK12" will be used to report online courses for grades K -12;

"CLBRVCLG" will be used to report online college-level courses.

A listing of DESE school codes can be found at:

<http://www.doe.mass.edu/infoservices/data/sims/schoolcodes.html>

Related Data Elements:

SIMS: DOE015 - School Identification Number

EPIMS: WA06 – Assignment Location Code

Notes:

The four character educational institution codes required to report courses provided by colleges are the same codes required to report EPIMS SR19 Degree Institution 1, SR 22 Degree Institution 2 and SR 25 Degree Institution 3. (See *EPIMS Data Handbook, Appendix C.*)

Element is similar to SIMS DOE015 **School Identification Number** and EPIMS WA06 **Assignment Location Code**.

“CLBR” must be all uppercase letters only. Lowercase letters will cause an error.\\

SIF Information

Object: SchoolInfo

Element: SchoolInfo/StateProvinceId

Values: <http://www.doe.mass.edu/infoservices/data/sims/schoolcodes.html>

SCS04 Local Course Code

The locally defined code that identifies the organization of subject matter and related learning experiences provided for the instruction of students.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 1 Maximum 20

Acceptable Values/Code Description:

Set by LEA. The complete set of printable characters available on a standard, English keyboard are allowed in this field.

Related Data Elements:

SIF Information

Object: SchoolCourseInfo

Element: DistrictCourseCode

Values: Alphanumeric

SCS05 Subject Area–Course Code

The State-defined code that identifies the organization of subject matter and related learning experiences, provided for the instruction of students.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 5 Maximum 7

Acceptable Values/Code Description:

00000 = Not Applicable. (Administrative staff should report “not applicable” in this field.)

99999 = All Subjects (This code is not acceptable for prior-to-secondary courses and is limited to SPED and EL courses for secondary courses.)

A complete list of subject area-course codes may be found in EPIMS Appendices

Related Data Elements:

EPIMS: WA10 – Subject Area-Course

Notes:

Table 1: Coding Format for Prior-to-Secondary and Secondary Subject Area-Courses

Subject Area	Code for Prior-to-Secondary Courses	Code for Secondary Courses
English Language and Literature	51	01
Mathematics	52	02
Life and Physical Sciences	53	03
Social Sciences and History	54	04
Fine and Performing Arts	55	05
Foreign Language and Literature	56	06
Religious Education and Theology	57	07
Physical, Health, and Safety Education	58	08
Military Science	-	09
Computer and Information Sciences	60	10
Communications and Audio/Visual Technology	61	11
Business and Marketing	62	12
Manufacturing	63	13
Health Care Services	64	14
Public, Protective, and Government Services	65	15
Hospitality and Tourism	66	16
Architecture and Construction	67	17
Agriculture, Food, and Natural Resources	68	18
Human Services	69	19
Transportation, Distribution, and Logistics	70	20
Engineering and Technology	71	21
Miscellaneous	72	22
Non-Subject Specific	73	-

SIF Information

Object: SchoolCourseInfo

Element: StateCourseCode

Values: Alphanumeric code from EPIMS Appendices

SCS06 Class Section

This field indicates the class assigned for a unique occurrence of a subject area-course. The class section code will identify the class assigned for that subject area-course and will be unique for the data collection within a school.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 1 Maximum 20

Acceptable Values/Code Description:

Set by LEA. An alphanumeric string of 20 characters or fewer. Special characters other than a hyphen, period, underscore, parentheses, forward slash and space are not acceptable.

Related Data Elements:

EPIMS: WA11 – Class Section

SIF Information

Object: SectionInfo

Element: CourseSectionCode

Values: Alphanumeric

SCS07 Course Term

The length of an individual course. For the purposes of reporting, the term sequence (e.g., 1st, 2nd, or 3rd trimester) must be provided in the value.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 2 Maximum 2

Code	Description
01	Full School Year
21	First Semester
22	Second Semester
31	First Trimester
32	Second Trimester
33	Third Trimester
34	Multiple Trimesters
35	Multiple Non-consecutive Trimesters
41	First Quarter
42	Second Quarter
43	Third Quarter
44	Fourth Quarter
45	Multiple Quarters
46	Multiple Non-consecutive Quarters
51	First Quinmester
52	Second Quinmester
53	Third Quinmester
54	Fourth Quinmester
55	Fifth Quinmester
56	Multiple Quinesters
57	Multiple Non-consecutive Quinesters
61	Mini-term 1
62	Mini-term 2
63	Mini-term 3
64	Mini-term 4
65	Mini-term 5
66	Mini-term 6
67	Mini-term 7
68	Mini-term 8
69	Mini-term 9
70	Mini-term 10
71	Mini-term 11
72	Mini-term 12
73	Mini-term 13
74	Mini-term 14
75	Mini-term 15
78	Multiple Mini-terms
79	Multiple Non-consecutive Mini-terms
80	Summer Term
90	Intersession

Term	Definition
Full school year	A regular school term consisting of no major subdivision of time segments. It usually begins in the late summer or early fall and ends in late spring or early summer (e.g., elementary school).
Intersession	A short session which occurs between longer sessions.
Mini-term	A school term which is shorter than a regular session.
Quarter	One of four equal segments into which a school year is divided.
Quinmester	One of five equal segments into which a school year is divided.
Semester	One of two equal segments into which a school year is divided.
Summer term	A school term which takes place in the summer between two regular school terms.
Trimester	One of three equal segments into which a school year is divided.

Related Data Elements:

EPIMS: WA16 – Course Term

Notes: All non-instructional staff should be reported as code 01 – FULL. Value must match course term values reported in EPIMS (WA16).

SIF Information

Object: TermInfo

Element: Extended Element: MATermCode

Values: Alphanumeric

SCS08 Course Enrollment Status

Indicates a student's status in each course in which they are or were enrolled. This includes any courses that:

- Are currently in session
- Were reported in a previous collection, as having students enrolled
- Started and concluded entirely between reporting periods

For example, in a given collection period a student's status is recorded as Enrolled for all courses currently in session and Completed, Withdrawn, Incomplete or Excused to reflect progress in all courses for which final marks have been reported.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 2 Maximum 2

Code	Description
01	Enrolled
02	Withdrawn
03	Completed
04	Incomplete
05	Excused

Related Data Elements:

SIF Information

Object: StudentSectionEnrollment

Element: Extended Element: CourseEnrollmentStatus

Values: Alphanumeric

SCS09 Course Level

An indication of the general nature and difficulty of instruction provided throughout a course.

The broad range of data models employed across the state means that the values used for SCS09 Course Levels will vary widely between districts. This means that data mapping will be required to capture the data in a standardized, usable format.

DESE has constructed a four-tiered data model that provides a robust and flexible data mapping structure for integrating and using the Course Level data. District data mapping involves evaluating actual data values in your local Student Information Systems and finding the most appropriate transformations to the DESE values.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 2 Maximum 2

Code	Description
01	Basic or Remedial: A course focusing primarily on skills development. The course offered may focus on the improvement of a particular deficiency in content previously taught but not learned.
02	General: A course providing instruction that focuses primarily on general concepts for the appropriate grade level.
03	Advanced: An advanced course designed for students who achieve a specified level of academic performance.
04	Postsecondary Credit: A course, often taken at or in conjunction with a postsecondary institution, which contains instruction equivalent to a college-level course and for which a student earns college credits.
05	Postsecondary Non-Credit: A course, often taken at or in conjunction with a postsecondary institution, which contains remedial or developmental content or for which a student does not earn college credits.

Related Data Elements:

SIF Information

Object: SchoolCourseInfo

Element: InstructionalLevel/Code

Values: Alphanumeric

SCS10 Course Credit Available

The number of credits that a student can earn for enrolling in and completing a given course. If course credits are not provided for this course, the “not applicable” code should be used.

Type: Decimal

Length: Minimum: 1 Maximum 5

Acceptable Values/Code Description:

Numerical entries assessed by the LEA. Value may contain up to 2 decimal places.

9999 = Not Applicable

Related Data Elements:

SIF Information

Object: SchoolCourseInfo

Element: CourseCredits

Values: Decimal

SCS11 Course Credit Earned

The number of credits awarded to a student who successfully meets the objectives of the course. If course credits are not provided for this course, the “not applicable” code should be used.

Type: Decimal

Length: Minimum 1 Maximum 5

Acceptable Values/Code Description:

Numeric value assessed by the LEA. Value may contain up to 2 decimal places.

9999 = Not Applicable.

Related Data Elements:

Notes:

If a course is currently in progress; the value for this element will be 0 or 9999 and will match the value reported in SCS10.

SIF Information

Object: StudentSectionMarks

Element: Extended Element: MACreditsEarned

Values: Decimal

SCS12 Course Letter Mark

A meaningful alphabetical or categorical expression of the performance of an individual. The results can be expressed in different ranges of passing marks (for example, ABC or ABCD) and/or levels (for example, A+, A, A-) or categories (for example, Pass/Fail).

The broad range of grading standards employed across the state means that the values used for SCS12 Course Letter Marks vary widely between districts. This means that data mapping will be required for categorical marks that conform to neither standard alphabetical nor Pass/ Fail grading systems.

DESE has constructed a multi-tiered data model that provides a robust and flexible data mapping structure to reliably capture Course Letter Marks data (values 16-20). District data mapping involves evaluating actual data values in your local Student Information Systems and finding the most appropriate transformations to the DESE values.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 2 Maximum 2

Code	Description
01	A+
02	A
03	A-
04	B+
05	B
06	B-
07	C+
08	C
09	C-
10	D+
11	D
12	D-
13	F
14	Pass
15	Fail
16	Failing (Very poor performance)
17	Minimally Acceptable (Lowest passing grade)
18	Acceptable (Meets some of the basic standards for the course)
19	Good (Meets standards for the assignment or course)
20	Outstanding (Meets the highest standards for the assignment or course)
21	Withdrawn
22	Withdrawn - Pass
23	Withdrawn - Fail
40	Incomplete
50	Excused
55	Mark is not required
66	Ungraded Course
77	Audit
88	Course In Progress
99	Numeric Mark (only) provided for this course

- If a letter mark is awarded for this course but will not be reported, SCS12 should be reported as 55.
- If the course is not graded, the value for SCS12 should be reported as 66.
- If this course was audited, the value for SCS12 should be reported as 77.
- If a course offered across non-consecutive terms is not completed and is not in session at the time of the collection, the Enrollment Status (SCS08) will be reported as “Enrolled,” and the value for this element will be reported as code “88” – Course In Progress.

Notes on Dependencies

- If the course has been completed and only a numeric mark has been provided, then the value for SCS12 should be reported as 99, and a numeric mark other than 99999, 88888, 21111, 22222, 23333, 40000 and 50000 must be reported in SCS13.
- If the course has been completed, and only a letter mark has been provided, then the value for SCS13 should be reported as 99999, and a letter mark other than 99, 88, 21, 22, 23, 40, and 50 must be reported in SCS12.
- If SCS08 is 01 (Enrolled), then SCS12 may be 55 (Mark will not be reported for this course), 66 (No grade provided for this course (ungraded)), 77 (Audit), 88 (Course In Progress) or 99 (Not Applicable).
- If the Enrollment Status (SCS08) for a student course is reported as “Completed”, a mark (letter, numeric, or both) is required.

Related Data Elements:

SIF Information

Object: StudentSectionMarks

Element: MarkList/Mark/Letter

Values: Alphanumeric

SCS13 Course Numeric Mark

Course numeric mark on a 100-point (percentage) scale. Value may contain up to 2 decimal places.

Type: Numeric

Length: Minimum 1 Maximum 5

Numeric value assessed by the LEA. Value may contain up to 2 decimal places, or:

Code	Description
21111	Withdrawn, no numeric grade provided
22222	Withdrawn, passing grade provided
23333	Withdrawn, failing grade provided
40000	Incomplete, no numeric grade provided
50000	Excused, no numeric grade provided
55555	Numeric mark is awarded for the course but it is not required that mark is reported
66666	Course not graded
77777	Course was audited
88888	Course in progress
99999	Numeric mark is not applicable

Notes on Dependencies:

- If SCS08 is 01, then SCS13 may be 55555, 66666, 77777, 88888, or 99999.
- If a numeric mark will be provided when the course is completed however the course is being offered at the time of the collection, the value for this element will be reported as 88888. In this case, SCS12 (Course Letter Mark) should have a value of "88".
- If the course has been completed, and only a letter mark has been provided, then the value for SCS13 should be reported as 99999, and a letter mark other than 99, 88, 21, 22, 23, 40, and 50 must be reported in SCS12.
- If the Enrollment Status (SCS08) for a student course is reported as "Completed," a mark (letter, numeric, or both) is required.
- If a course offered across non-consecutive terms is not completed and is not in session at the time of the collection, the Enrollment Status (SCS08) will be reported as "Enrolled," and the value for this element will be reported as code 88888 or 99999.

Related Data Elements:

SIF Information

Object: StudentSectionMarks

Element: MarkList/Mark/Percentage

Values: Numeric

SCS14 Pathways Course

Indicates that a particular course is being used to meet the student's technical course taking requirement for Perkins, Early College or Innovation Pathway programs.

Type: Alphanumeric

Length: Minimum 2 Maximum 2

Code	Description
00	Non-Pathways Course
01	Pathways Course

Notes:

More information on Early College and Innovation Pathways: [Massachusetts High Quality College and Career Pathways Initiative - College, Career and Technical Education](#)

More information on Perkins: [Perkins Funding - College, Career and Technical Education](#)

SIF Information

Object: StudentSectionEnrollment

Element: Extended Element: PathwaysCourse

Values: Numeric

Revision History

Version	Date of Change	Description
9.5	10/1/26	2026-27 school year
9.4	10/1/25	Fixed links on the SCS14 page
9.3	10/1/24	Added SIF Information to SCS14
9.2	10/1/23	Remove EDW references
9.1	8/13/21	Remove outdated instructions on SCS02 SASID page
9.0	10/1/20	Added SCS14 Pathways Course element
8.0	8/9/17	SCS09: Added now code 05 for non-credit post-secondary courses.
5.0	1/20/17	SIF Information added to each element.
4.0	8/20/13	SCS06: Added forward slash to acceptable characters. - Moved to v4 for consistency
1.5	5/10/13	- Moved History to back - Changed allowable characters for SCS06
1.4.3	9/20/11	Sent for posting. Changed date to 9/20/2011.
1.4.3	9/18/11	- SCS03 - Added (See <i>EPIMS Data Handbook, Appendix C.</i>) to notes. - SCS05 – added SPED to 99999 definition.
1.4.2	9/15/11	- Light edit. - Changed date to 9/15/11.
1.4.2	7/28/11	- Modified SCS03: School/Program ID Number - Modified SCS05: Subject Area – Course Code 99999 definition: 99999 = All Subjects (This code is not acceptable for prior-to-secondary courses and is limited to SPED and ELL courses for secondary courses.) Secondary “all courses” codes will be validated to make sure they are only for SPED or ELL work assignments in the secondary grades. Prior-to-Secondary Codes (format = 5 digits: _ _ [subject area] _ _ [course]) Use the new NCES prior-to-secondary course codes (see <i>Table 1</i>). The first two digits identify the subject area and the next three digits identify the specific course. The 99999 code <i>is not acceptable</i> for prior-to-secondary courses. Secondary “all courses” codes will be validated to make sure they are only for SPED or ELL work assignments in the secondary grades. Updated Table1 with new codes.
1.4.2	6/29/11	Link in SCS05 broken again. Fixed.
1.4.2	1/3/11	Link in SCS05 section points to wrong page. Corrected to point to the Subject Area Course Codes.

1.4.2	12/20/10	Modified SCS03 – “CLBR” must be in uppercase.
1.4.1	11/10/10	Modified SCS07 – Added five more acceptable values (70 – 75) for mini-term.
1.4	10/26/10	- Modified SCS05 – Removed Special Education and Special Education Services codes (23 and 73) from the tables. - Modified SCS11- If a course is currently being taught; the value for this element will be 0 or 9999 and will match the value reported in SCS10.
1.4	9/21/10	Removed PILOT Watermark.
1.3	6/29/10	- For better maintenance, removed pages numbers from the Revision History, referring instead to changes by Section Heading. - Moved document title, version, page #, and date, back to the footer (instead of the header). Removed location of documentation from the footer, which has moved from H to Sharepoint. - Reformatted bulleted list of SCS Data Elements, as a two-column table. - Under the section for SCS13 Course Numeric Mark, reformatted acceptable values/code descriptions, in tabular format. - Created an index.
1.2	4/13/10	- Under the section for SCS13, updated the description for SCS13, as follows: - Values must indicate course mark on a 100-point (percentage) scale. Value may contain up to 2 decimal places. - Under the sections for SCS12 and SCS13, updated descriptions of dependency validations to reflect the modified rules. - Updated location of source document in the footer, date, TOC page numbers, and made general production edits.

1.1	3/25/10	- Added watermark and pathname in the footer. - Changed doc version number. - Under sections for SCS 12 and SCS13, updated the note, which now indicates: If the course has been completed, and only a letter mark (<i>not numeric</i> mark) has been provided, then the value for SCS13 should be reported as 99999, and a letter mark other than 99 must be reported in SCS12. - Under SCS 12 and SCS13, added new descriptions, with modified rules. - Under SCS 12 and SCS 13, reorganized note lists by code values/descriptions and dependencies. - Continued to reorganize descriptions and dependencies. Removed redundant dependency.
1.0	3/11/10	Under SCS08 Course Enrollment Status., removed “will be” from the last sentence.
0.4	1/8/10	- For SCS12 and SCS13 sections, modified notes to require both data elements to be reported as in progress (if one is reported as in progress). - For SCS12 and SCS13 sections, clarification provided to notes to the effect that not applicable codes should be reported only for completed courses.
0.3	12/23/09	- Changed SCS08 Course Enrollment Status Code 05 from “Excused for Medical Reasons” to “Excused” - Revised SCS12 Course Letter Mark to include codes 21-50 and changed description of code 55 from “Mark will not be reported for this student” to “Mark not required” - Addition to note indicating if SCS12 is 99 then the value reported in SCS13 must not be 99999 - Revised SCS13 Course Numeric Mark to include codes 21111-50000 and changed description of code 55555 to indicate the mark is not required - Added text to indicate if SCS13 is 99999, then the value reported in SCS13 must not be 99.
0.2	11/23/09	- Added Appendix A; - Page 14 - Revised SCS07: Course Term values
0.1	11/23/09	Initial version